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Dolphins in the estuary. Perth up the line.

Mandurah is a city built around water: a vast, sheltered estuary, canals threading through the suburbs and a long Indian Ocean coast, all under an hour south of Perth. Once the place Perth went for its holidays, it has grown into one of Western Australia's fastest-growing cities, and a lovely base for clinicians who want a coastal life with the capital close at hand.

~90,000

people in Greater
Mandurah

~50 min

by train to central Perth

2×

the size of Sydney
Harbour: the Peel-
Harvey estuary

~40 min

inland to the jarrah
forest at Dwellingup

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Guides describe places, not employers. Hospitals are described rather than named, and salaries, visas and registration rules change, so we confirm the detail with you directly.

Why clinicians choose Mandurah

People are drawn to Mandurah for the water and the space, and they stay for the easy, outdoor rhythm of a city that still feels like a coastal town.



If you're looking for the buzz of a capital on your doorstep and the most complex tertiary work in your own building, Mandurah may not be it. But if you're drawn to estuary mornings, room for the family and Perth just up the train line, it could be a wonderful choice.

Mandurah's great gift is a genuine waterside life. Depending on where you live, that might be a canal at the bottom of the garden, the calm estuary for paddling and crabbing, or a surf beach on the Indian Ocean side, and in most of the city all three are within a short drive. Dolphins feed in the estuary and the marina, pelicans patrol the foreshore, and evenings tend to end with the sun going down over the sea.

It also offers space and value. Housing here generally costs less than in Perth's coastal suburbs, and because Mandurah is still growing, new schools, estates and services are being built rather than stretched. Families often find they can have a bigger home, a shorter run to the beach and a calmer week than they could closer to the city.

For work, the city has a busy regional health campus that is being expanded, a strong community and primary care network and a steady private imaging presence. The Mandurah train line reaches central Perth in around fifty minutes, so a role in the city while living on the coast is a realistic plan rather than a stretch.

WHAT YOU GAIN

Life on the water

Estuary, canals and ocean in one city: paddleboarding before work, crabbing in summer and dolphins in the bay.

Space and value

Generally more home for your money than in coastal Perth, with newer family estates to the north and south.

Perth within reach

A fast train and a direct freeway put the capital's hospitals, airport and city life under an hour away.

A growing city

New housing, schools and a major expansion of the local hospital campus: a place on the way up.

GOOD TO KNOW

Tertiary work is in Perth

The most complex and subspecialty care is an hour north. It suits you best if you enjoy a broad general caseload, or are happy to commute for the rest.

Warm, dry summers

Summers are long and hot, softened by the afternoon sea breeze. A home with good shade and cooling makes them a pleasure.

A car-friendly city

Outside the rail corridor, most families run a car. Worth planning for when you choose where to live.

A relaxed pace

Mandurah is unhurried and outdoorsy rather than busy and urban. If that is what you are after, you will settle in quickly.



Pelicans on the shore at Mandurah: the estuary's birdlife is part of everyday life here



Clear, shallow water on the Mandurah coast, minutes from most homes

A city shaped by the estuary

Mandurah makes most sense once you see that it is built around an estuary rather than a high street. Where people live, how they spend their weekends and how long anything takes all follow from the water.

The city wraps around the mouth of the Peel-Harvey estuary, one of the largest estuarine systems in Australia, where the Serpentine, Murray and Harvey rivers meet the sea. The Peel Inlet and the long Harvey Estuary spread out behind the coast, roughly twice the size of Sydney Harbour, and the Dawesville Cut, a channel opened in the 1990s, links the estuary to the ocean and keeps its water fresh and clear.

The city centre, the marina and the rebuilt Eastern Foreshore sit right on the water, with canal estates threading the suburbs around them. To the north, newer family suburbs stretch along the rail line towards Rockingham and Perth; to the south, Halls Head, Falcon and Dawesville run along a dune coast towards Yalgorup National Park. Inland lie Pinjarra, farmland and then the forested Darling Scarp.

Around 90,000 people live in Greater Mandurah, about seventy kilometres south of the Perth CBD, at the meeting point of the Perth region and the South West. For a long time it was a holiday and retirement town; since the railway arrived in 2007 it has become a city of young families, commuters and people who simply love the water.

~70 km

south of the Perth CBD

About an hour's drive, or
fifty minutes by train

Two coasts

estuary and ocean

Flat water on one side, the
Indian Ocean on the other

UTC+8

Western Standard Time

No daylight saving, the
same clock as Singapore

Summer

DEC - FEB

Hot, dry and sunny, often in the thirties, with the afternoon sea breeze cooling the coast most days. Crabbing season, long beach evenings and bushfire season, so keep an eye on the official alerts.

Autumn

MAR - MAY

Many locals' favourite time: the water is still warm, the days are settled and the city's crab festival fills the foreshore in March.

Winter

JUN - AUG

Mild and green, with most of the year's rain arriving on Indian Ocean fronts. Cool rather than cold, and lovely for forest walks inland.

Spring

SEP - NOV

Wildflowers in the bush, warming days and, by the end of it, the first proper swims of the season.

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A note on Country

Mandurah stands on Bindjareb (also written Pinjarup) Noongar Country, part of the wider Noongar nation of the south-west. The estuary has sustained Bindjareb people for tens of thousands of years, and the city's name is widely understood to come from the Noongar word Mandjar, a meeting place, which you will see in names like Mandjar Bay. Inland, Pinjarra carries an important and painful chapter of the region's history, which the community remembers openly. Your cultural induction is a good place to begin learning, and Acknowledgement of Country opens many meetings and events.

Bindjareb Country

TENS OF THOUSANDS OF YEARS

The estuary, its fish and its birdlife sustain Bindjareb Noongar people long before European arrival.

A fishing settlement

19TH CENTURY

European settlers follow the sheltered water and the fishing; Mandurah stays a small crabbing and holiday village for decades.

The Cut and the canals

1990S

The Dawesville Cut opens to the ocean and canal estates reshape the waterfront. The town begins to grow quickly.

The railway

2007 ONWARD

The Mandurah line brings Perth within an hour, families and commuters arrive, and the holiday town becomes a city.



Spring in the Western Australian bush, when wildflowers bloom across the south-west



Calm water is a big part of the Mandurah story: the estuary and canals are made for paddling

Healthcare and work in Mandurah

Mandurah gives you a busy regional health base with Perth's tertiary system close enough to lean on, and a local hospital campus in the middle of a major expansion.

The Peel region's main hospital is a general health campus in Mandurah that looks after a large and growing population across the city and its surrounding shires, with emergency, surgical, medical, maternity and outpatient services. Since 2024 it has been run directly by one of the state's metropolitan public health services, which links it closely with the tertiary teaching hospitals in Perth's south.

A significant redevelopment is under way, bringing more inpatient beds, an extra operating theatre, chemotherapy places, a palliative care hospice, expanded outpatients, new medical imaging services and more mental health care. For clinicians, that means a campus that is growing its services and its teams, and a good moment to join.

Around the hospital sits a broad community network: general practices, community and mental health services, Aboriginal community-controlled health care, and a steady private imaging and pathology presence across the city. The most complex, high-acuity and subspecialty work is concentrated in Perth's tertiary hospitals, under an hour north, and patients move up and down that pathway as they need to.



Regional teams see a broad general caseload, with Perth's tertiary hospitals close behind them

MANDURAH

The local health campus

The region's main public hospital: emergency, general medicine and surgery, maternity and outpatients, now expanding.

~50 MIN NORTH

Perth's tertiary hospitals

Major teaching and referral centres for complex, subspecialty and trauma care, and a natural next step for training.

ACROSS THE PEEL REGION

Community and primary care

General practice, community and mental health services, and Aboriginal community-controlled health organisations.

ACROSS THE CITY

Private imaging and pathology

A steady private sector, especially in medical imaging, serving a growing and active population.

For medical imaging, which is where much of our current Western Australian recruitment sits, the local picture usually means a broad general caseload in Mandurah, with more of the subspecialty and interventional work weighted towards the city. Many clinicians enjoy exactly that variety, and the short train ride means professional development, conferences and colleagues in Perth are never far away.

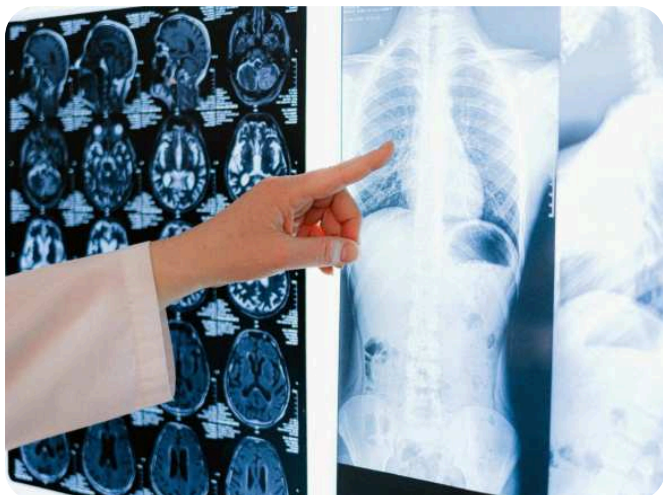
What to ask at interview

- ☐ What is the case and modality mix, and which equipment will you be working with?
- ☐ How much of the specialist work stays local, and how much is referred to Perth?
- ☐ The roster: shift patterns, on-call frequency and how cover works across sites.
- ☐ What supervision and orientation you will have in your first months, particularly if this is your first role in Australia.
- ☐ How the hospital redevelopment will change the service and your team over the next few years.
- ☐ Pay follows WA awards and agreements; we quote no figures and will walk you through the current one for your profession.
- ☐ Salary packaging, relocation support and funded CPD, including time for courses in Perth.

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Registration and licensing

You will need Ahpra registration through your profession's National Board before you can practise, and the same registration covers the whole country. Medical radiation practitioners also need a Western Australian radiation licence, a state requirement on top of registration. Start both early: paperwork is usually what sets your start date. As in the rest of Western Australia, Mandurah is currently treated as regional for skilled migration, so ask us how that might help you.



Imaging roles here offer a broad general caseload, with subspecialty work close by in Perth



Community and regional care is close to the people it serves



Paediatric and allied health work brings real variety to a regional caseload



General practice and community clinics are a big part of care across the Peel region



A growing campus means growing teams, and many colleagues have trained overseas too

Where to live in Mandurah

In Mandurah the first question is not which suburb but which water, and how close to the train you would like to be. Answer those two and the shortlist almost writes itself.

~10 MIN · ESTUARY & OCEAN

Halls Head & Erskine

Just across the bridge from the centre, between the estuary and the beach: established streets, canal homes and the ocean at the end of the road.

~5–10 MIN · WATER AT THE DOOR

Dudley Park & the canals

Canal and estuary frontage, sometimes with a mooring at the end of the garden. The postcard end of the market, priced accordingly.

WALK TO THE MARINA

Mandurah centre & the foreshore

Apartments and older homes near the Eastern Foreshore, cafés, the marina and the bus link to the station. The most walkable part of the city.

~10–15 MIN · FAMILY ESTATES

Meadow Springs & Lakelands

Newer family suburbs to the north with parks, schools and a train station at Lakelands. Popular with commuters heading to Perth.

~15 MIN · BEACHSIDE NORTH

Madora Bay & San Remo

Quiet beachside estates on the ocean coast north of the city, with bigger blocks and newer homes.

~15–20 MIN · SOUTH COAST

Falcon & Dawesville

Relaxed coastal suburbs to the south near the Dawesville Cut, with beaches, the estuary and Yalgorup National Park nearby.

~10 MIN · CENTRAL VALUE

Greenfields & Coodanup

Central, affordable suburbs close to the hospital, the main shopping centre, TAFE and the university campus.

~20–25 MIN · COUNTRY TOWN

Pinjarra & the hills

A historic river town inland, with farmland, horse country and the forest close by. Lovely for space; plan ahead for the bushfire season.

Most newcomers rent for six months to a year before choosing for good. A useful exercise is to rank three things in your own order: which water you want to be near (canal, estuary or ocean), how much space you would like for the money, and how close to the Mandurah line you need to be if Perth is part of your plan. It is rare to have all three in one street, and being clear on your order is what leads you to the right part of the city.

If your work is in Mandurah itself, almost anywhere in the city is a short drive. If you will commute to Perth, look first at the northern suburbs near Lakelands station or at homes with an easy run to Mandurah station's park-and-ride.



A shaded suburban playground in Bunbury, an hour south: parks like this are a feature of new estates across the region



On the ocean side of the city, the beach is part of the after-school routine

Before you sign a lease

- ☐ Which water is it near, and how do you want to use it: boating, paddling, swimming or surfing?
- ☐ How long is the drive to your workplace, and to Mandurah or Lakelands station if you will use the train?
- ☐ Cooling and shade: what kind of air conditioning is there, and does the home catch the sea breeze?
- ☐ On the bushland fringe or inland: what is the bushfire rating, and what is the plan?
- ☐ Is it in the local-intake area for the public school you want? Places are linked to your address.

Getting around Mandurah

Mandurah is an easy, car-friendly city with one great asset: a fast train that reaches the heart of Perth in under an hour.

The Mandurah line is part of Perth's Transperth network. Trains run from Mandurah station, with Lakelands station serving the northern suburbs, up the freeway corridor through Rockingham to the Perth CBD in around fifty minutes, with park-and-ride along the way. Local buses connect the suburbs to the station, and the same SmartRider card (or a contactless bank card) works on trains and buses alike.

Day to day, most people drive. Getting across town usually takes fifteen to twenty minutes, and traffic is rarely a daily event. The Kwinana Freeway and Forrest Highway carry you north to Perth and south to Bunbury and the South West, and there are no toll roads in Western Australia. The foreshore and marina are lovely on foot, and shared paths follow much of the estuary and coast, so a bike is a happy addition.

FROM MANDURAH TO	ROUGHLY	HOW
Across town	15–20 min	Drive
Rockingham	~20–30 min	Train or drive
Perth CBD	~50 min train, ~1 hr drive	Train or drive
Perth Airport	~1 hr 10 min	Drive
Fremantle	~50 min	Drive, or train and bus
Dwellingup	~40 min	Drive
Bunbury	~1 hr	Drive
Margaret River	~2 hr 15 min	Drive



Central Perth at blue hour: around fifty minutes from Mandurah on the train

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Driving licences

Licence conversion is handled by the WA Department of Transport, which has a centre in Mandurah. Licences from many countries can be converted without a driving test, but there is a time limit for driving on an overseas licence once you live here, so check their 'moving to WA' guidance soon after you arrive. Australians drive on the left; take care with kangaroos around dawn and dusk on country roads.

Worth planning for

- ✓ One car works well if you live near the rail line; two is common in the outer estates.
- ✓ Transperth's journey planner covers both the train and the local buses.
- ✓ If you will commute to Perth, try the journey at your real start time before you choose a suburb.

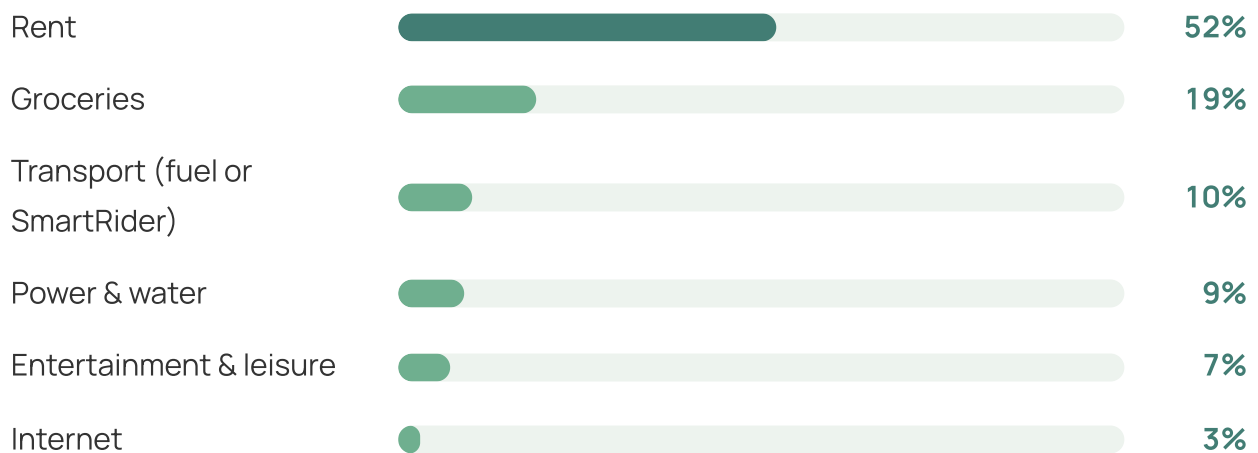
What it costs to live here

Living in Mandurah generally costs less than in Perth's coastal suburbs, especially on housing, and the best things here, the water, the beaches and the sunsets, are free.

We don't print prices in our guides, because a figure that is right today can mislead a year from now. What stays true is the shape of the budget. Housing is where Mandurah shines: for similar money you are usually closer to the water than in comparable Perth suburbs, and the newer estates offer more house again. Groceries, services and everyday costs sit broadly in line with the rest of the Perth region.

Two lines are worth planning for: keeping a home comfortable through a long, warm summer, and the cost of distance, whether that is fuel or fares for a Perth commute or the drive to the airport for trips home. Public-health roles can also salary-package part of your pay before tax, which helps the monthly sums.

Where a month goes



These are shares of a mid-range monthly budget for one person, not amounts. Rent is still the biggest line, and in Mandurah it usually takes a smaller share than in Perth's coastal suburbs.

COMPARED WITH PERTH

Housing

Generally less than coastal Perth, with more space and water views within reach.

Everyday spending

Groceries, eating out and services are broadly similar to the rest of the Perth region.

WORTH PLANNING FOR

Summer cooling

A shaded home that catches the sea breeze does a lot of the work for you.

Distance

Fuel or fares if you commute, and the hour's drive to the airport for flights home.



Beach days, estuary paddles and foreshore picnics cost nothing, which is why weekends here go so far



Camping under the trees is a classic, inexpensive weekend in Western Australia's south-west

IN SHORT

- ✓ Housing is the big win: generally more space, and more water, for your money than in coastal Perth.
- ✓ Everyday costs are much like Perth's; plan for summer cooling and the cost of the commute if you will use the city.
- ✓ The setting-up period (bond, rent in advance, a car) is the same wherever you land, so budget for it from the start.



SOPHIE'S INSIGHTS

What I tell people about Mandurah

Mandurah is the place I suggest when someone tells me they want the sea, space for the children and a gentler pace, but do not want to be cut off. You can stand on the foreshore watching dolphins in the morning and be in central Perth for lunch, and that combination is quite rare.

The conversation I always have is about the work itself. The local campus is growing and the caseload is broad and rewarding, while the most specialised work is an hour up the line. If you love variety, or you are happy to make that short trip when your career needs it, Mandurah can give your family a beautiful life by the water, and I love seeing people discover it.

Sophie Careem

Founder & Director, Ethicare Resourcing



Central Perth at dusk: the city is under an hour up the line from Mandurah

Food, shopping and everyday life

In Mandurah the estuary sets the table. Blue swimmer crabs, fresh seafood and waterfront cafés are at the heart of the everyday, and much of life is lived outdoors.

The Peel estuary is famous for its blue swimmer crabs, and crabbing with a scoop net in the shallows or a drop net off a jetty is a genuine local institution, enjoyed within the seasonal size and bag rules. Each March the city celebrates with the Mandurah Crab Fest on the foreshore, one of the biggest free festivals in the state. Fish and chips at the marina, a seafood lunch overlooking the water and a coffee on the Eastern Foreshore round out a very Mandurah weekend.

For the weekly shop, Woolworths, Coles, ALDI and IGA are all here, with Mandurah Forum on Pinjarra Road the largest shopping centre. The Mandjar Markets bring local makers and food to the Eastern Foreshore on Sundays through the warmer months, and there are seasonal twilight and winter markets too. For a wider range of Asian, Indian, African and halal groceries, many families combine a trip to Rockingham or Perth's southern suburbs with a day out.

SUMMER AND AUTUMN

Crabbing

Wade the shallows with a scoop net or drop a net off a jetty. Check the current rules with the state fisheries department first.

CITY CENTRE

The Eastern Foreshore

Cafés, restaurants, playgrounds, the boardwalk and the Sunday markets, all along the water.

MARCH

Crab Fest

A free weekend festival of food, music, cooking demonstrations and fireworks on the foreshore.

PINJARRA ROAD

Mandurah Forum

The main shopping centre, with supermarkets, department stores and plenty of places to eat.



Long lunches and shared tables are a big part of weekend life



Café culture on the waterfront: brunch is a favourite local ritual



Western Australian seafood is superb, from Fremantle sardines to Peel estuary crabs

An ordinary week here has an easy, outdoor rhythm: a walk or a swim before work, children's sport after school, the beach or the estuary while the light lasts and a barbecue on the foreshore at the weekend. Mandurah is friendly and community-minded, and its multicultural community is growing, with active Filipino, African, German-speaking and Muslim community groups, a Gaelic football club started by Irish locals, and the City's own multicultural networking group. Our local directory lists places to start.

Everyday Mandurah, in one list

- ✔ Learn the crabbing rules, buy a scoop net and give it a go.
- ✔ Fish and chips at the marina, watching for dolphins.
- ✔ Sunday coffee and the markets on the Eastern Foreshore.
- ✔ A trip north for specialist groceries, combined with a beach or a day in Fremantle.



Flavours from home are easy to cook here, with specialist grocers a short trip north



The foreshore cafés make the morning flat white a local ritual



Weekend brunch, Australian style



Western Australia shares a time zone with South-East Asia, and its food shows it



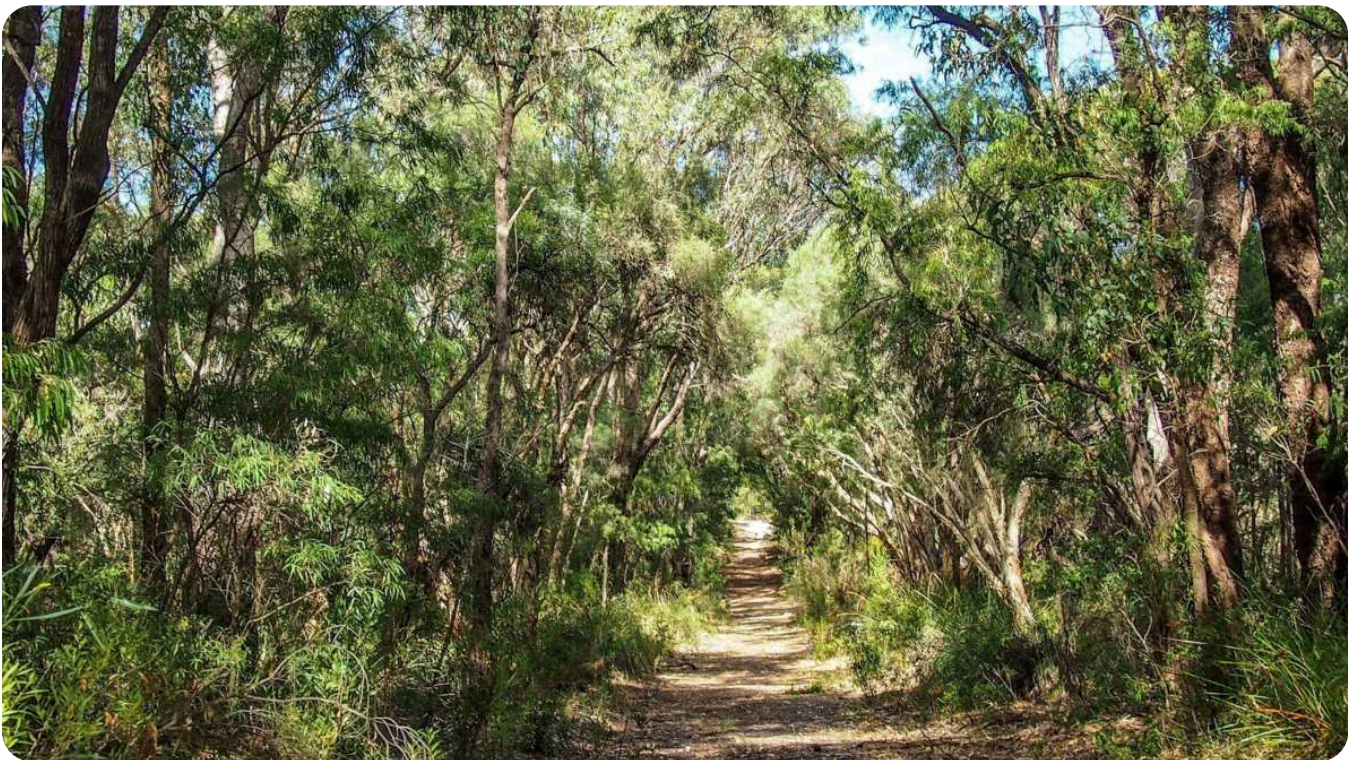
Japanese, Thai, Indian and more:
the city's food scene keeps
growing with its people

What people do at the weekend

From Mandurah, weekends go three ways: out onto the water, inland to the jarrah forest, or south to a national park of quiet lakes and beaches.

Start with the water. Bottlenose dolphins live in the estuary and are often seen in Mandjar Bay, around the marina and along the canals, and an estuary cruise is a lovely first weekend. Kayaking and paddleboarding on the calm water, fishing from the jetties, crabbing in the shallows and swimming at the ocean beaches fill most summer weekends, and the foreshore boardwalk is made for an evening stroll.

About forty minutes inland, Dwellingup is the gateway to the northern jarrah forest: walking on the Bibbulmun Track, cycling on the Munda Biddi Trail, mountain biking, canoeing and whitewater on the Murray River, and the Hotham Valley heritage train. It stays cooler than the coast in summer and is green and misty in winter. To the south, Yalgorup National Park protects a chain of quiet lakes, coastal woodland and beaches, and at Lake Clifton you can see thrombolites, living rock-like structures that echo some of the earliest life on earth.



A walking track through the woodland of Yalgorup National Park, south of the city

IN TOWN

Dolphins and the estuary

Take a cruise, hire a kayak or simply watch from the boardwalk: the dolphins are locals too.

~40 MIN · JARRAH FOREST

Dwellingup

Forest walks on the Bibbulmun Track, the Munda Biddi cycle trail, river swims and a country-town pie.

~30 MIN · SOUTH

Yalgorup & Lake Clifton

Quiet lakes, coastal woodland, birdlife and the remarkable thrombolites on the lake's edge.

~20 MIN · INLAND

Pinjarra

A historic river town with heritage buildings, riverside parks, cafés and a well-loved festival calendar.

~30 MIN · NORTH

Rockingham & Penguin Island

Sheltered beaches, snorkelling and a ferry to an island home to little penguins and sea lions.

~50 MIN-1 HR · NORTH

Perth & Fremantle

Markets, galleries, the port city's cafés and everything a capital offers, close enough for a spontaneous day.



On the ocean side of the city, a surf before breakfast is easy to fit in



Camping weekends in the forest and on the coast are part of growing up in the south-west



Quokkas on Rottnest Island, a ferry ride from Fremantle and a favourite day out from Mandurah



Shared paths under the gums in Perth's Kings Park, an easy day trip by train



A beach in Bunbury, about an hour south

Eight weekends to start with

- ✓ A dolphin cruise on the estuary, then fish and chips at the marina.
- ✓ A forest walk and a swim in the Murray River at Dwellingup.
- ✓ Paddleboarding on the canals on a still morning.
- ✓ The train to Perth for a day in the city and Kings Park.
- ✓ Crabbing in the shallows on a summer evening.
- ✓ The thrombolites and lakes of Yalgorup National Park.
- ✓ Crab Fest on the foreshore in March.
- ✓ A long weekend in Margaret River's wine and surf country.

Around Mandurah

Mandurah sits right at the hinge between the Perth region and the South West, so both the capital and some of Western Australia's most beautiful country are within easy reach.

Head north and you are quickly in Rockingham, with its sheltered beaches and Penguin Island, then Fremantle and Perth, with the state's international airport, its tertiary hospitals and the culture of a capital. Head south on the Forrest Highway and Bunbury, the main city of the South West, is about an hour away, with its own dolphins and a lively waterfront. Beyond it lie Busselton's famous jetty and the vineyards, surf beaches, caves and karri forests of Margaret River, an easy long weekend.

Inland, the Darling Scarp rises into jarrah forest at Dwellingup, with the Bibbulmun Track and the Munda Biddi Trail running north and south through the trees. And when the family wants snow, the nearest ski fields are a flight east: around four hours to Melbourne, then a drive into the Victorian Alps, which many West Australians make into a winter adventure.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Town Beach & the ocean beaches (nearest beach)	~5-10 min	Swimming, surfing and sunsets on the Indian Ocean, with the calm estuary on the other side of town.
Victorian Alps ski fields (nearest snow)	~4 hr flight + ~3-4 hr drive	The nearest ski fields are a flight east from Perth, then into the mountains: a memorable winter holiday.
Perth (nearest city)	~1 hr drive, ~50 min train	The state capital: tertiary hospitals, Kings Park, the Swan River, Fremantle and city life.
Perth Airport	~1 hr 10 min	Flights across Australia and direct international services to Asia, the Middle East and Europe.
Dwellingup & the Bibbulmun Track	~40 min	Jarrah forest, river swims, mountain biking and some of the state's best walking.
Yalgorup National Park	~30 min	Lakes, coastal woodland and the ancient thrombolites of Lake Clifton.
Rockingham	~30 min	Sheltered beaches, snorkelling and the ferry to Penguin Island.
Bunbury & the South West	~1 hr	A friendly coastal city with dolphins, beaches and a waterfront to explore.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Margaret River	~2 hr 15 min	Wineries, surf breaks, caves and karri forest: the classic long weekend.

ON YOUR DOORSTEP

The Peel estuary

Dolphin cruises, crabbing, kayaking and birdlife across one of Australia's largest estuaries.

~40 MIN · EAST

Dwellingup

A forest town on the Bibbulmun Track and the Munda Biddi Trail, with the Murray River close by.

~30 MIN-1 HR · NORTH

Rockingham & Perth

Island ferries, city beaches, Fremantle's markets and everything a capital offers.

~1-2.5 HR · SOUTH

Bunbury, Busselton & Margaret River

The South West: dolphins, a two-kilometre jetty, wineries, surf and tall forests.



The Busselton jetty, on the way to Margaret River, about an hour and three-quarters south



Bunbury, the main city of the South West, about an hour south



Sunset on the coast at Bunbury



Kings Park and the Perth skyline, around an hour north



Fremantle's heritage streets, about fifty minutes north



Wine country is a lovely long weekend away in Margaret River

Families and schools in Mandurah

Mandurah is a wonderful place for children: beaches, calm water, parks and sport everywhere, and a growing city that keeps building new schools for its young families.



Home time: the school day here finishes early enough for the beach



Calm estuary water makes kayaking and sailing an easy part of childhood here

Western Australian schooling begins with Kindergarten, a part-time, non-compulsory year for four-year-olds, usually at the local primary school. Pre-primary is the first compulsory year, then primary school runs from Year 1 to Year 6 and secondary school from Year 7 to Year 12, finishing with the WA Certificate of Education (WACE) and, for university entry, an ATAR. Across four terms, the school year starts in early February and finishes in mid-December.

There are three sectors. Public schools are run by the WA Department of Education and enrol by local-intake area, so your home address decides your guaranteed local school. Catholic schools are part of Catholic Education Western Australia (Mandurah sits in the Diocese of Bunbury), and independent schools, many of them faith-based, set their own enrolment and fees. Mandurah has a good spread of all three, including long-established schools such as John Tonkin College (public), Mandurah Catholic College, Mandurah Baptist College and Frederick Irwin Anglican School, as well as newer public colleges in the growth suburbs.

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School fees on a temporary visa

If you come on a temporary visa, Western Australia may charge a fee for your children to attend a public school. For the common skilled work visas this is a yearly fee charged per family rather than per child, administered on behalf of the WA Department of Education by TAFE International WA. Check the current rules for your visa on the Department's page for children who are dependants of visa holders before you plan your budget, and ask your employer whether they help with it.

Choosing a school

- ☐ Check the local-intake area for the exact address before you sign a lease, using the Department of Education's Schools Online finder.
- ☐ Look at a school's profile on the My School website, and visit or ask for a video call.
- ☐ If your child is still building their English, ask how the school's English as an Additional Language or Dialect (EAL/D) support works.
- ☐ Uniforms are usually sold through the school's own uniform shop, often run by the parents' association, which also sells good second-hand items.
- ☐ Catholic and independent schools can have waiting lists, so contact them early.

What children tend to love here

- ☒ Spotting dolphins from the boardwalk, and a cruise on the estuary.
- ☒ Surf-lifesaving 'Nippers' at the ocean beaches and swimming lessons from an early age.
- ☒ The foreshore playgrounds and the summer water play areas.
- ☒ Crabbing on warm evenings with a scoop net and a bucket.
- ☒ Forest camping and river swims at Dwellingup.
- ☒ Club sport for every age: Aussie rules, soccer, netball, basketball, cricket and more.

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Early childhood

For younger children, Mandurah has long day care centres, family day care and playgroups in most suburbs. Fees can be reduced by the Australian Government's Child Care Subsidy, though whether you qualify depends on your visa; Services Australia can confirm before you budget.



Kindergarten in WA is usually part-time and based at the local primary school



Secondary school runs from Year 7 to Year 12, ending with the WACE

GREENFIELDS

Murdoch University, Mandurah campus

A university campus in the city itself, focused on health, including undergraduate nursing.

MANDURAH CAMPUS

South Metropolitan TAFE

Vocational courses and apprenticeships, plus free English classes through the Adult Migrant English Program for eligible migrants.

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Perth's universities

The University of Western Australia, Curtin, Murdoch's main campus, Edith Cowan and Notre Dame, all within commuting distance.



Mandurah gives you the water every day, and the city whenever you want it.

Your Mandurah address book

Mandurah's multicultural community is smaller than Perth's but warm and growing, with an active Filipino-Australian community, African and German-speaking groups, a Muslim cultural association that runs Friday prayers in the city, and Irish locals who started their own Gaelic football club. The City of Mandurah keeps a multicultural community directory and a networking group, and Perth's larger Indian, Malayali and South African communities are an easy train ride north.

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City of Mandurah

The city council: bins, libraries, recreation centres, events and the multicultural community directory

08 9550 3777 mandurah.wa.gov.au

Shire of Murray

Council for Pinjarra, Dwellingup and the surrounding rural area inland of Mandurah

murray.wa.gov.au

City of Rockingham

Council for Rockingham and the suburbs between Mandurah and Perth

rockingham.wa.gov.au

Visit Mandurah

The official visitor centre and website, with dolphin cruises, events and things to do

visitmandurah.com

Transperth

The Mandurah line, local buses, SmartRider and the journey planner

transperth.wa.gov.au

healthdirect

Round-the-clock health advice from a registered nurse, free from anywhere in the country

1800 022 222 healthdirect.gov.au

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City of Mandurah: Multicultural Mandurah

The City's multicultural page, with its community directory, a multicultural networking group that meets quarterly and a regular newsletter.

08 9550 3777

mandurah.wa.gov.au/our-city/multicultural-mandurah

Peel Multicultural Association

Local not-for-profit offering advocacy, social support, referrals and practical workshops to help newcomers settle in.

Mandurah Filipino-Australian Multicultural Community Inc.

Long-running Filipino community group sharing culture through dance, arts and crafts and community celebrations.

Mandurah Filipino Sports Club Inc.

Basketball and volleyball club set up to bring the Filipino community together.

Mandurah African Women's Group

Meets to celebrate African dance, culture and food and to organise events for significant celebrations.

Peel Islamic Cultural Association (PICA)

Not-for-profit association representing Muslims in Mandurah since 2014, with a community centre in the city and weekly Friday prayers.

picamandurah.com

Mandurah Celtics Gaelic Football Club

Gaelic football club founded for Irish locals in Mandurah, training and playing in the Perth league. A friendly first stop for Irish and UK arrivals.

Malayali Association of Perth (MAP)

Perth's Malayali association, with Onam and Vishu celebrations and support for newly arrived families; the nearest Kerala community network to Mandurah.

mapconnect.org.au

Office of Multicultural Interests (WA Government)

Statewide services directory and community events calendar, useful for finding South African, Zimbabwean, Nigerian, Sri Lankan and other associations in Perth.

omi.wa.gov.au

Adult Migrant English Program (AMEP), South Metropolitan TAFE

Free English classes for eligible migrants, with an AMEP centre in Mandurah. Register within six months of your visa start date or arrival.

1800 862 166

southmetrotafe.wa.edu.au/adult-migrant-english-program-amep

Citizens Advice Bureau

Free information and referral on everyday questions, from tenancy to consumer matters.

08 9535 3101 cabwa.com.au

Peel Community Legal Services

Free legal advice for people in the Peel region.

08 9581 4511 peelcls.com.au

Peel Multicultural Association

The association's Facebook page, listed in the City of Mandurah's multicultural directory.

facebook.com/PeelMulticulturalAssociationInc

Mandurah Filipino-Australian Multicultural Community

Facebook page for the Filipino community and sports club, listed in the City of Mandurah's multicultural directory.

facebook.com/MFAMCI

German-Speaking Community of Mandurah

Monthly coffee mornings, summer picnics and winter dinners for German speakers; listed by the City of Mandurah.

facebook.com/groups/deutschinmandurah

Our Lady's Assumption Parish (Catholic)

Mandurah's Catholic parish, part of the Diocese of Bunbury, with weekend Masses including a Sunday evening youth Mass.

08 9582 7390 bunburycatholic.org.au

St Joseph Syro-Malabar Parish, Perth

Syro-Malabar Catholic parish whose area runs south to Mandurah, with Malayalam Qurbana at several Perth centres; the Kwinana centre is the closest.

syromalabarperth.org.au

Christ's Church Anglican Parish of Mandurah

Historic Anglican church on the corner of Sholl Street and Pinjarra Road, with Sunday and weekday services and a children's programme.

08 9535 6152 anglicanchurchmandurah.org.au

Mandurah Uniting Church

Uniting Church congregation at 156 Pinjarra Road.

unitingchurchwa.org.au/mandurah

The Salvation Army Mandurah

Sunday worship at 10am at 45-51 Lakes Road, Greenfields, with community support and a Salvos Store on site.

salvationarmy.org.au/mandurah

Peel Islamic Cultural Association: Friday prayers

Jumu'ah prayers held weekly in Mandurah; check the association's website for the current venue and times.

picamandurah.com

Ar-Rukun Mosque, Rockingham

Mosque at 4 Attwood Way, Rockingham, about half an hour north, opened in 1998.

Perth Bala Murugan Temple

South Indian (Tamil) style Hindu temple at Mandogalup, near Kwinana, around half an hour north of Mandurah, with daily pooja.

perthmurugan.org.au

Sikh Association of WA Gurdwara

Gurdwara in Canning Vale, Perth, with Sunday prayers and langar; around fifty minutes north.

Buddhist Society of Western Australia

Meditation classes, Dhamma talks and retreats at centres around Perth.

bswa.org

Perth Hebrew Congregation

Modern Orthodox synagogue in Menora, Perth, serving the WA Jewish community since the 1890s.

thephc.com.au

Halal food: ask PICA

The Peel Islamic Cultural Association can point you to current halal-certified butchers and stores in Mandurah and Rockingham.

picamandurah.com

Perth's southern and central suburbs

For the widest choice of Asian supermarkets, Indian grocers, halal butchers and African and South African stores, many Mandurah families shop in Cannington, Willetton or Northbridge, combined with a day in the city.

Kosher food: ask the congregation

The Perth Hebrew Congregation can advise on kosher food and suppliers in WA.

thephc.com.au

Woolworths

National supermarket chain with several stores across Mandurah; online delivery and click-and-collect.

woolworths.com.au

Coles

National supermarket chain with several stores across Mandurah; online delivery and click-and-collect.

coles.com.au

ALDI

Discount supermarket, good for a lower-cost weekly basket.

aldi.com.au

IGA

Independent local supermarkets in several suburbs.

iga.com.au

Mandurah Forum

The region's largest shopping centre, at 330 Pinjarra Road, with Coles, Woolworths, Kmart and around 200 stores and eateries.

mandurahforum.com.au

Mandjar Markets

Sunday markets on the Eastern Foreshore with local makers, food and entertainment, mainly through the warmer months; check the City's events calendar for dates.

mandurah.wa.gov.au/explore/whats-on/calendar/community-event/mandjar-markets

Schools Online (WA Department of Education)

Find a public school and check its local-intake area for an exact address.

det.wa.edu.au/schoolsonline

Fees for dependants of temporary visa holders

WA Department of Education information on public school fees for children of temporary visa holders, administered by TAFE International WA.

tafeinternational.wa.edu.au/wa-government-schools/children-who-are-dependants-visa-holders

Catholic Education Western Australia

Runs Catholic schools across WA, including Mandurah's; enrolment information and school finder.

cewa.edu.au

Association of Independent Schools of WA (AISWA)

Peak body for WA's independent schools, with a school finder by region.

ais.wa.edu.au

My School

National website with profiles and results for every Australian school.

myschool.edu.au

School uniforms

Most Mandurah schools sell uniforms through the school's own uniform shop, often run by the parents' association (P&C), which usually also sells second-hand items. Ask the school office for opening times.

Circle Green Community Legal

Free statewide tenancy advice for renters.

08 6148 3636 circlegreen.org.au

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Transperth

The Mandurah line and local buses, with the journey planner, timetables and SmartRider information.

transperth.wa.gov.au

Department of Transport: moving to WA

How to transfer or convert an interstate or overseas driver's licence when you move to Western Australia.

13 11 56

transport.wa.gov.au/licensing/drivers-licence/visit-move-wa

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realestate.com.au

Australia's largest rental and sales listings site.

realestate.com.au

Domain

Rental and sales listings, with suburb profiles.

domain.com.au

Flatmates.com.au

Rooms and shared houses, useful for the first few weeks.

flatmates.com.au

Bonds Administration (Consumer Protection WA)

Holds rental bonds in WA until the end of a tenancy; explains bond limits, lodging and releasing a bond.

consumerprotection.wa.gov.au/rental-bonds

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Numbeo: Mandurah

Crowd-sourced prices for Mandurah; contributor numbers are small, so compare it with the Perth page too.

numbeo.com/cost-of-living/in/Mandurah-Australia

Numbeo: Perth

Crowd-sourced prices for Perth, a useful benchmark for the wider region.

numbeo.com/cost-of-living/in/Perth

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Checked October 2026

Community groups, shops and pages change. If a link has moved or you know a group we should add, tell us and we will update the guide.

Numbers and websites to keep handy

The national services every newcomer uses, wherever in Australia you land.

000 112 13 11 14 13 11 26 1800 022 222 1800 882 436 132 011

Emergency services

Police, fire and ambulance, any time
000

Emergency from a mobile

Also connects to emergency services from any mobile phone
112

healthdirect

Free 24/7 health advice from a registered nurse
1800 022 222 [healthdirect.gov.au](https://www.healthdirect.gov.au)

Lifeline

24/7 crisis support and suicide prevention, by phone, text or chat
13 11 14 [lifeline.org.au](https://www.lifeline.org.au)

Poisons Information Centre

24/7 advice if someone may have been poisoned
13 11 26

Pregnancy, Birth and Baby

Free support for parents from pregnancy to preschool
1800 882 436 [pregnancybirthbaby.org.au](https://www.pregnancybirthbaby.org.au)

132 011 132 011

Medicare · Services Australia

Enrolment, cards, claims and reciprocal health care agreements
132 011 [servicesaustralia.gov.au/medicare](https://www.servicesaustralia.gov.au/medicare)

healthdirect service finder

Find a GP, pharmacy, urgent care or hospital near you
[healthdirect.gov.au/australian-health-services](https://www.healthdirect.gov.au/australian-health-services)

privatehealth.gov.au

Compare private health cover independently; run by the Commonwealth Ombudsman
[privatehealth.gov.au](https://www.privatehealth.gov.au)

Private health insurance complaints

The Commonwealth Ombudsman's free complaints service
1300 737 299 [ombudsman.gov.au](https://www.ombudsman.gov.au)

1300 737 299

Department of Home Affairs

Visas, skilled occupation lists and processing times
[immi.homeaffairs.gov.au](https://www.immi.homeaffairs.gov.au)

ImmiAccount

Lodge and track your visa application online
online.immi.gov.au

Register of migration agents (OMARA)

Check an agent is registered before you pay
[mara.gov.au](https://www.mara.gov.au)

Ahpra

National registration and the National Boards
1300 419 495 [ahpra.gov.au](https://www.ahpra.gov.au)

Fair Work Ombudsman

Awards, pay rates and your rights at work
13 13 94 [fairwork.gov.au](https://www.fairwork.gov.au)

13 13 94

NSW school finder

Government schools and catchments in New South Wales
[education.nsw.gov.au/school-finder](https://www.education.nsw.gov.au/school-finder)

Find my school (Victoria)

School zones for any Victorian address
[findmyschool.vic.gov.au](https://www.findmyschool.vic.gov.au)

Find a school (Queensland)

State schools and catchment areas
qld.gov.au/education/schools/find

Find a public school (WA)

Western Australian public schools and local-intake areas
wa.gov.au/service/education-and-training/school-education/find-public-school

School zones (South Australia)

Zone maps for government schools
education.sa.gov.au/parents-and-families/enrol-school-or-preschool/zones-catchments-and-capacity-management/maps-school-zones-enrolment-year

Find your local school (Tasmania)

Intake areas for Tasmanian government schools
decyp.tas.gov.au/learning/find-your-local-school

Priority enrolment areas (ACT)

Find a Canberra public school for your address
act.gov.au/education-and-training/find-a-school-and-enrol

Choose a school (NT)

Urban and remote schools in the Northern Territory
nt.gov.au/learning/primary-and-secondary-students/choose-a-school

Starting Blocks

Compare childcare services and quality ratings near you
startingblocks.gov.au

Child Care Subsidy

Eligibility, rates and how to apply
servicesaustralia.gov.au/child-care-subsidy

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Australian Taxation Office

Apply for your tax file number (TFN), tax and super
13 28 61 ato.gov.au

Moneysmart

Free, independent budgeting, super and banking tools
moneysmart.gov.au

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TIS National

Free interpreting by phone, 24/7, in 150+ languages
131 450 tisnational.gov.au

Settle in Australia

Home Affairs' settlement topics and services for new arrivals
immi.homeaffairs.gov.au/settling-in-australia

MyAus app

Government app to help newcomers find services, in many languages
myausapp.com

Overseas drivers (Austroads)

How overseas licences are recognised, with links to each state's licensing authority
austroads.gov.au/drivers-and-vehicles/overseas-drivers/country-recognition



Always check the source

Rules, fees and services change. Treat these as starting points and confirm details with the organisation. Ethicare are recruitment specialists, not registered migration agents.

Six steps, and someone beside you for each one

Moving country is a sequence of decisions. We take them with you in order, so you are never solving step five before step two is done.



STEP 1

Discovery call

A relaxed conversation about your profession, your family and what you want from a move. No forms, no pressure.



STEP 2

Eligibility & registration

We map your route to Ahpra registration and help you gather the evidence the regulator will ask for.



STEP 3

Opportunities & interviews

Roles matched to where you want to live and how you like to work, with honest briefings before every interview.



STEP 4

Offer & decision support

We help you read the offer properly: pay step, relocation support, roster and what the team is really like.



STEP 5

Visa & relocation guidance

Practical guidance on visas, shipping, pets, schools and the first weeks, so nothing arrives as a surprise.



STEP 6

Settling in

We stay in touch after you land, from your first week on the ward to your first winter.



— READY TO EXPLORE OPPORTUNITIES?

Picture yourself in Mandurah. Then let's make it real.

Tell us what you do and where you would like to live. We will come back with roles that fit, a clear view of the registration route, and time to answer every question.



Ethicare Resourcing

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